



Marva Abouei

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Portfolio	↗
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About me

Product designer with a master's in Human-Computer Interaction and 6+ years of experience designing human-centred, intuitive, accessible digital solutions that drive user delight and growth. Skilled in UX/UI and service design with a research-driven approach, strong usability focus, and proven cross-functional collaboration. Currently leading product design at ISM Creative, Vancouver, Canada.

Education

Master of Human-Computer Interaction

Uppsala University, Sweden
Sep 2019 – Jun 2021

User Experience Design Certificate

Emily Carr University Art + Design
Sep 2021 – Apr 2022

Experience

Lead Product Designer

Sep 2024 – Present

ISM Creative

Lead end-to-end MVP design and delivery for early-stage startups across web, mobile, and XR platform. Combine user research, product strategy, and advanced UX/UI design to transform complex requirements into intuitive experiences. Collaborate closely with cross-functional stakeholders to ensure alignment, feasibility, and seamless execution within lean, fast-paced teams.

AI-Driven Psychoeducational Assessment

SaaS

B2B2C

Selected project

- Led end-to-end product design for an AI-driven assessment platform used by psychologists, special education professionals, and parents to screen children with learning differences and generate personalised learning plans.
- Designed intelligent workflows and interfaces where automated NLP analysis and real-time reporting work alongside human review, enabling clinicians to validate AI-generated insights with full transparency and control during high-stakes assessment workflows.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with product manager, engineers, and clinical advisors to define personas, map user journeys, and translate complex workflows into clear, intuitive interaction models.
- Conducted user research, usability testing, and heuristic evaluations, synthesising insights into actionable design improvements that reduced cognitive load and improved completion rates.
- Advocated for transparency, privacy, and ethical AI, incorporating explainability and user controls to build trust in automated insights.
- Aligned rapid prototyping with iterative development sprints, enabling stakeholder demo delivery and early validation with B2B clients.

UX/UI Designer

May 2022 – Aug 2024

ISM Creative

- Led end-to-end UX/UI design across web, desktop, mobile, and immersive products.
- Raised SUS score from 49 to 86 by simplifying interactions for first-time VR users and contributed to early-stage funding success by aligning UX enhancements with business goals.
- Boosted traffic by ~37% and conversions by ~19% through optimised navigation, cut load times by about 40% and improved navigation efficiency by ~60% via data-driven design.

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Skills

Human-centred design, user and market research, competitive analysis, persona, journey mapping, user stories, systems thinking, product strategy, roadmapping, UX metrics and KPIs

Concept maps, service blueprinting, information architecture, responsive design, web accessibility (WCAG 2.2)

Ideation, user flow diagram, wireframing, iterative prototyping, style guides, design systems management

Heuristic evaluation, A/B testing, usability testing, project management, agile methodology, risk and dependency management

Tools

Figma, Claude, Photoshop, Miro, Jira, Notion, Google Analytics, Google Workspace, GitHub, UserTesting, Hotjar, Optimal Workshop, ChatGPT, FlutterFlow, AppSheet, Webflow, WordPress, Framer, EditorX, HTML & CSS

Certificates

- UX for AI: Design Practices for AI Devs
- Usable Security
- UX Research for Agile Teams
- Designing with WCAG 2.2 Guidelines
- Conducting Usability Testing

Experience, continued

UX/UI Designer	May 2022 – Aug 2024
ISM Creative	
- Conducted user research, developed personas, mapped user journeys, and wireframed solutions that aligned user goals with business outcomes. - Built and maintained scalable design systems that streamlined developer hand off and accelerated product delivery. - Mentored junior designers and led UX workshops to foster a culture of excellence. - Participated in design reviews, usability testing, and sprint planning, advocating for user needs while supporting timely, high-quality delivery.	

UX/UI Designer	Nov 2020 – May 2022
Harmony Group	
- Redesigned an e-commerce website and streamlined information architecture, reducing complexity by ~20%. - Conducted card sorting and usability testing to refine navigation and information structure. - Achieved a ~45% boost in task success, ~10% increase in conversions, and a ~15% reduction in bounce rate within 3 months post-launch.	

Mentorship

Startup Mentor	Aug 2026 – Present
BIPOC Foundation · Remote	
Selected as a mentor for founders participating in the BIPOC Founders Hub Accelerator. I help early-stage startups translate business ideas into buildable, people-centred products by balancing user needs, technical feasibility, and business goals — mentoring on product strategy, discovery and MVP definition; customer validation and product-market fit; AI product experiences and workflows; product design and user experience; and product leadership across design, engineering, and business.	

Volunteer

XR Product Designer	Jul 2025 – Dec 2025
Icosa Foundation	
Contributing UX/UI enhancements to Open Brush, an open-source VR painting application, partnering with developers to improve usability, interaction flows, and overall experience (~5 hrs/week).	
UX UI Designer	Apr 2024 – Apr 2025
curaJOY	
Redesigned check-in flow to boost completion, built AI insights dashboard for identifying behavioural patterns to build healthy habits, and added gamification to increase retention (~5 hrs/week).	